

Phones for all?

India's GSM subscriber base has crossed 580 million users, with more than 11.11 million new subscribers in April

All HD on Airtel

Airtel digital TV HD and HD-DVR set-top boxes will now upscale all SD channels to HD-like quality

Google Android vulnerability fix

In the second half of May, folks over at University of Ulm in Germany determined that all Android phones running any version below Android 2.3.4 Gingerbread are vulnerable to attacks over unencrypted Wi-Fi networks. That pretty much means that around 99.7 percent of Android users are at risk.

The German researchers published their findings in a paper entitled 'Catching AuthTokens in the Wild: The Insecurity of Google's ClientLogin Protocol'. Vulnerability is specific to unencrypted Wi-Fi hot spots, where the team demonstrated an attack that gained access to such items as contacts, calendar events and private pictures, including those currently being synced.

By stealing authToken, the

hackers can theoretically access a variety of other Google services on the phone. The best solution is to upgrade to Android 2.3.4, but upgrades are hard to come by.

Three or four days after the vulnerability was reported, Google began rolling out a fix, and users were not required to make any changes. It's quite apparent that the fix being rolled out is all back-end, with the way the network handles credentials, connecting to a more secure HTTPS server instead. However, the fix doesn't resolve all issues, and the third-party Gallery app will still leak data when communicating with Picasa.

Response was relatively quick, but the flaw shouldn't have existed in the first place. Connecting to open Wi-Fi networks with mobile devices is not good anyway. ■

NVIDIA launches GeForce GTX 560

NVIDIA has launched its latest Fermi-based performance mainstream GPU, which is a slightly more diminutive, cheaper and less able version of the GTX 560 Ti (Titanium), though it has faster clocks. Priced at ₹9,029, it is poised to take on the popular Radeon HD 6870 and consistently outperforms the GTX 460, effectively replacing it. It is based on the GF114 Fermi architecture, the GeForce GTX 560 has been advertised as sufficient to take on today's latest games – including 3D games – at 1080p HD resolutions. The GTX 560 has 336 stream processors, 56 texture units, 32 ROPs, 7 tessellation engines and a 256-bit memory controller.

NVIDIA has given its add-on partners a wide range of clock speeds to place their offerings within, with a core-clock range of 810 - 950MHz, shader clock range from 1,620 - 1,900 MHz,

and a memory clock range from 4 - 4.4 GHz. It is rated to deliver 1.08 TFLOPS of single-point precision compute performance, when clocked at 810 - 1620 MHz, and can max out at 1.27 TFLOPS when clocked at 950 - 1900 MHz. Apart from DX 11, PhysX, 3D Vision, OpenGL 4, and CUDA is supported.

NVIDIA has released its



latest GeForce drivers, 275.27 beta, promising 3D vision support for Duke Nukem Forever, PhysX support to Alice: Madness Returns and surround support to Dungeon Siege III. Performance improvements are expected across a broad spectrum of games, with Crysis 2 getting a 6 percent boost, Bulletstorm a 15 percent boost and Portal 2 an 8 percent boost. ■

Airtel Facebook USSDN

Airtel has launched the world's first Unstructured Supplementary Service Data (USSD) based Facebook access service in India. This service allows you to access everyone's favourite social network without an internet connection. Airtel users will be able to update their Facebook status for free, and for ₹1 a day, view/comment/Like news feeds, post on walls, confirm friend requests, find and add friends, and view

notifications.

Because USSD is a session-based communication, unlike SMS, which is transaction-based, it has significantly faster response times, and is more suited for content-based and interactive applications. It functions somewhat like

a menu-based browser. The technology is unique to GSM, and is a built-in way to transmit data over signal channels. Airtel's USSD solution is based on Fonetwisch, developed by U2opia Mobile. ■

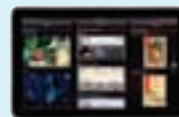


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